Calling a Claude model through Amazon Bedrock

GROUP QUIZ

Core questions 1-5

Choose one answer for each question. Discuss your reasons as a group before checking with the instructor. Questions 1-20 are the core set; questions 21-25 are optional. These are learning questions, not exam predictions.

1. Kestrel asks whether the assistant could read photographs of router labels that customers send. How does this requirement affect the choice of model?

A. It rules out every candidate without image input before any evaluation of answer quality.
B. It adds a test of image questions, but text-only candidates stay on the list until testing ends.
C. It changes nothing at first, because a model's modalities are measured during the optimise step.
D. It requires fine-tuning a text model on router photographs before the evaluation can begin.

2. Two candidate models score similarly on a published benchmark. Why does the course still evaluate them on Kestrel's own cases?

A. Benchmarks can use other tasks and data, so only Kestrel's cases show quality, latency and cost.
B. Bedrock publishes benchmark results only for Amazon models, so the Claude models have no comparable score.
C. A benchmark score expires when a model enters the Legacy state, so the team needs current results.
D. Kestrel's cases are needed to fine-tune each candidate before its quality can be compared fairly.

3. Kestrel wants summaries of each day's closed cases by the next morning, at the lowest price per call. Which way of calling the model suits this work?

A. ConverseStream suits it, because streaming returns each summary sooner and costs less per call.
B. Batch inference suits it, because it reads requests from S3 and writes the results to S3 later.
C. The global profile suits it, because its lower price outweighs Kestrel's data-location rule.
D. Prompt caching suits it, because every summary request shares one short system prompt.

4. A team setting up a new AWS account finds that the model it planned to use is in the Legacy state. What does this mean for the team?

A. The team can't adopt the model as a new customer, so it should choose an Active model instead.
B. The team can use the model until its end-of-life date, as every customer of a Legacy model can.
C. The team can call the model only through batch inference, which Bedrock keeps for Legacy models.
D. The team pays a lower Legacy price, which makes the model a good choice for routine work.

5. Kestrel's finance team wants to attribute the cost of the course model to each application. Why must an application inference profile for that model be created from the EU profile, not from the base model?

A. An application profile created from a base model costs more, because it bypasses the EU price.
B. Bedrock serves the course model only through inference profiles, so the copy must be of a system profile.
C. Only the EU profile carries tags, so a profile copied from it inherits the tags that finance needs.
D. A profile created from the base model would route calls to every commercial Region, as a global one does.

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Core questions 6-10

6. A learner's call from London returns the ValidationException that asks for an inference profile. Which response to the error does the course recommend?

A. Change the source Region to one where the base identifier accepts on-demand calls.
B. Ask the account owner for bedrock:InvokeModel on the base model's ARN in London.
C. Retry the call with backoff, because the error means that London is short of capacity.
D. Check that the client sends config.MODEL_ID, and keep eu-west-2 as the source Region.

7. AWS opens a new European Region that can serve the course model. How does this affect calls that the assistant sends through the existing EU profile?

A. The EU profile adds the new Region automatically, so calls can run there without any change.
B. The calls start to run in the new Region once the learner policy allows invocation there.
C. Its destinations stay the same, and the team would change identifier to use a new profile.
D. The calls run in the new Region only when the client names that Region as its source Region.

8. The global profile for the course model costs about 10 per cent less than the EU profile. Why does the course use the EU profile for Kestrel?

A. Kestrel's data must stay in Europe, and the global profile could process calls in any commercial Region.
B. London doesn't offer the global profile for the course model, so the EU profile is the only one available.
C. The global profile charges each destination Region's price, which is often higher than London's price.
D. The global profile needs Provisioned Throughput, which the course account hasn't bought for the model.

9. A colleague proposes changing MODEL_ID in config.py to a different profile. What does MODEL_CHOICE_REASON in the same file help the colleague do?

A. It lets Bedrock pick the destination Region that best matches the reason that the file records.
B. It records the requirement that the choice meets, so a change can be checked against it.
C. It supplies the reason that IAM checks before it allows a call to the profile that MODEL_ID names.
D. It sets the model that Strands uses when a sample omits the identifier, so samples follow the course.

10. A model appears in aws bedrock list-foundation-models for London, but calls to it fail with AccessDeniedException. What should the team check next?

A. Check the model's quota, because an exhausted quota returns AccessDeniedException for new accounts.
B. Check the AWS CLI version, because older versions list models that the account can't yet call.
C. Check the model's context window, because Bedrock refuses requests that are too long as access errors.
D. Check the account's agreement status, because a catalogue entry shows only what the Region offers.

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Core questions 11-15

11. A learner sets both temperature and topP in one Converse request to Claude Haiku 4.5. What does the handbook say about this?

A. Bedrock averages the two settings, so the reply varies less than either setting alone would allow.
B. The model ignores topP whenever temperature is set, so the request behaves as if topP were absent.
C. The model accepts one setting or the other, not both, so the course client sets only temperature.
D. Both settings belong in additionalModelRequestFields, because Converse defines neither of them.

12. The course client sets MAX_ATTEMPTS to 6, BACKOFF_BASE_SECONDS to 2 and BACKOFF_CAP_SECONDS to 32. What is the longest that one call to converse() can spend waiting between attempts before it gives up?

A. It can wait up to 32 seconds, because the cap limits the total wait for one call.
B. It can wait up to 94 seconds, because the client waits after each of its six attempts.
C. It can wait up to 64 seconds, because the ceiling doubles once more after the cap.
D. It can wait up to 62 seconds, the sum of the five ceilings from 2 to 32 seconds.

13. A developer suggests calling InvokeModel with Claude's own request body instead of Converse. What would Kestrel lose?

A. It would lose streaming, because InvokeModel has no form that returns the reply in events.
B. It would lose its IAM control, because InvokeModel needs no permission for model invocation.
C. It would lose portability, because code for one provider's body doesn't move to another model.
D. It would lose the EU profile, because InvokeModel accepts only base model identifiers in London.

14. The Converse API defines nine stop reasons. Which three does the course client treat as a complete reply?

A. It treats end_turn, max_tokens and stop_sequence as complete, because each ends the reply normally.
B. It treats end_turn, tool_use and guardrail_intervened as complete, because each ends one turn.
C. It treats end_turn, stop_sequence and content_filtered as complete, because each reply is usable text.
D. It treats end_turn, stop_sequence and tool_use as complete, and records every other one as rejected.

15. Why does the course client select content blocks by type instead of reading message["content"][0]["text"] directly?

A. The first block holds the system prompt, so the model's own text always starts in the second block.
B. Bedrock returns the blocks in a random order, so the text can be at any position in the list.
C. Each block repeats the whole reply, so reading only the first one would duplicate the text.
D. The first block isn't always a text block, and a reply that requests a tool holds a toolUse block.

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GROUP QUIZ

Core questions 16-20

16. A call returns ModelErrorException with HTTP status 424. What does the course client do?

A. It retries with backoff and jitter, because the error comes from the model, as ModelNotReadyException does.
B. It stops and records the attempt, because the code isn't one of the four in RETRYABLE_CODES.
C. It retries once without waiting, because a model error usually clears on the next request.
D. It returns the error message as the reply text, so the caller can show the customer what failed.

17. A call with 2,000 input tokens and 300 output tokens uses the course model at 1.10 USD per million input tokens and 5.50 USD per million output tokens. What does the call cost?

A. It costs 0.00385 USD, from 2,000 tokens at the input price and 300 at the output price.
B. It costs 0.00253 USD, from all 2,300 tokens at the input price, as the usage total shows.
C. It costs 0.01133 USD, from 2,000 tokens at the output price and 300 at the input price.
D. It costs 0.01265 USD, from all 2,300 tokens at the output price, which applies to the reply.

18. The client stops waiting for a response after its read timeout, so the attempt has no usage. How does the ledger record the attempt's cost?

A. It records a cost of zero, because no response arrived and so no tokens can be billed.
B. It records the cost of max_tokens at the output price, as the most the attempt could cost.
C. It records a null cost and sets usage_known to false, because tokens may have been generated.
D. It records nothing, because only attempts that return a response receive a ledger row.

19. A learner adds a cache checkpoint after Kestrel's system prompt and its two tool definitions, but the usage shows no cache fields. What is the most likely explanation?

A. Claude models use implicit caching only, so Bedrock ignores any cachePoint block in the request.
B. The checkpoint made the call fail silently, so the reply came from a retry without the checkpoint.
C. The prefix is shorter than the 4,096-token minimum for the course model, so Bedrock doesn't cache it.
D. Caching works only with batch inference, so on-demand calls never return cache fields in their usage.

20. A summary of case_1028 returns with the stop reason end_turn and passes CaseSummary validation, but its case_id is case_1003. Why does the application also compare the identifier with the case it asked about?

A. The validator ignores case_id, because the field has no pattern in the JSON Schema that Bedrock receives.
B. end_turn means that the model ran out of tokens, so later fields may come from another case.
C. Native structured output changes the identifier when the schema's pattern doesn't match it.
D. A schema checks only the answer's shape, so a valid summary can still describe the wrong case.

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Optional extra questions 21-25

21. A learner wants Bedrock's native structured output for CaseSummary. Which part of a schema would Bedrock refuse?

A. It would refuse a pattern on case_id, because Bedrock doesn't accept patterns in a schema.
B. It would refuse maxLength on next_step, because native output doesn't support length limits.
C. It would refuse additionalProperties set to false, because that setting blocks optional fields.
D. It would refuse a schema description, because Bedrock reads only the field names and types.

22. Code, not a person, consumes the assistant's case summaries. Why does the course advise against streaming those answers?

A. Streaming needs bedrock:InvokeModelWithResponseStream, which the example policy doesn't allow.
B. Streamed replies cost more per token, because each event carries its own share of the usage.
C. Streaming can't return JSON, so a structured answer must use Converse with native output.
D. Code needs the whole answer and its stop reason before it validates, and they arrive at the end.

23. The demonstration injects a ThrottlingException with botocore's Stubber, then a stubbed reply, and the client recovers. What does this result prove?

A. It proves that the client's own error handling, retry decision and ledger rows work as designed.
B. It proves that Bedrock throttles the account at its quota and recovers within the backoff time.
C. It proves that the account's request quota is high enough for the class's workload this week.
D. It proves that the model returns a valid answer after a throttle, because the reply came back.

24. Why does the course client turn off boto3's own retries with total_max_attempts set to 1?

A. boto3 retries every error, including AccessDeniedException, so its retries waste attempts.
B. SDK retries happen inside client.converse(), so the ledger couldn't record each attempt separately.
C. boto3's standard mode retries without backoff, which makes throttling worse for the account.
D. Bedrock refuses requests from clients that use SDK retries, to protect its shared capacity.

25. A request for a long answer raises ReadTimeoutError. Why doesn't the client retry it?

A. A read timeout means that Bedrock refused the request, so a retry would fail in the same way.
B. A read timeout counts against the request quota, so a retry would cause a ThrottlingException.
C. The client stopped waiting, but the request may have run, so a retry could incur a second charge.
D. The SDK has already retried the timeout five times inside the call, so the limit has been reached.